

Are there any statistics when it comes to the energy used / carbon emissions released due to AI video generation?

Posted by u/MopManXD69420 • 0 points • 4 comments

I made a [similar post]

(https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/comments/1lh6dhf/is_the_environmental_impact_of_using_ai_concerning/) a month ago (thx for all the responses btw), but after seeing people commenting under goofy AI videos about how harmful they are I'm starting to become cautious again especially considering the fact that if a video is 30FPS and goes on for 8 seconds then that's 240 images generated. These videos also use AI speaking in sync with it + the creator might've done this 4× before finding the best version + said creator has hundreds of these videos

Here's all the info that I've read about AI's impact on the environment (none of them mention AI videos - to my awareness): ["AI and climate change"](<https://www.iea.org/reports/energy-and-ai/ai-and-climate-change>), a [Wiki article] (https://en.m.wikipedia.org/wiki/Environmental_impact_of_artificial_intelligence), "[Using ChatGPT is not bad for the environment]"(<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/individual-ai-use-is-not-bad-for>) and "[AI's shocking growth from 0.0064% of energy use in 2024 to 0.017% in 2025]"(https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/comments/1l7n8eb/ais_shocking_growth_from_00064_of_energy_use_in/)"

Comments

u/Inside_Anxiety6143 • 1 points • 2025-07-22 19:04 UTC

AI video's aren't generated frame by frame. Just like images aren't generated pixel by pixel. Videos are deconstructed into tokens. A token can be an element of several frames at once.

u/IndependenceSea1655 • 1 points • 2025-07-22 16:20 UTC

[An MIT article](https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/comments/1lfcw2x/mit_study_your_brain_on_chatgpt/?utm_source=share&utm_medium=web3x&utm_name=web3xcss&utm_term=1&utm_content=share_button) i shared awhile back had some articles with stats about the energy usage. i don't think they were specifically about video generation, but if LLM queries use 10x the energy of search engine queries I cant imagine the video generation isnt using more energy too

<https://preview.redd.it/4ev3h3czagef1.jpeg?width=653&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=73f099da9d933efd22742fc03b7785215d19b921>

u/ShagaONhan • 2 points • 2025-07-22 16:07 UTC

I don't know each time I see one of these clickbait article they inflate the energy numbers by x100 to the point that my all electric wiring would fry each time I generate an image and my house would have been burned ten times.

There is improvement to make on energy consumption but that's not going to be achieved with fake numbers for ragebait.

u/Tyler_Zoro • 1 points • 2025-07-22 15:50 UTC

> if a video is 30FPS and goes on for 8 seconds then that's 240 images generated.

This is not how video works, and AI video generation did start the way you describe (generating individual frames). But we've moved on from there. Video generation works on the four-dimensional "image" that is the entire video. This is why video sequences are so constrained in time: they are literally working on the entire video clip as a single unit.

And just as with images, it is the network processing that is consuming time, not the dimensions of the result. It does not take a linearly longer amount of time to generate an image in 512x512, 1024x1024 and 2048x2048, for example.

Similarly, a video generation would not require a linearly longer amount of time for a 1280x720 video at 2 seconds, 4 seconds and 8 seconds.